Tableau Project Documentation: Sales vs Target Performance Analysis

1. Project Overview

This project presents a comprehensive analysis of actual sales performance in comparison to predefined sales targets using data from the *SALES_RECORDS* and *TARGET_SALES* datasets. The objective of the dashboard is to evaluate whether sales targets have been achieved across multiple dimensions, including time, geography, and product categories.

The dashboard is designed to provide clear, data-driven insights into performance trends, enabling stakeholders to identify areas of underperformance, recognize periods of strong growth, and make informed business decisions. By integrating multiple visualizations into a single interface, the project emphasizes both analytical depth and ease of interpretation.

2. Data Sources and Preparation

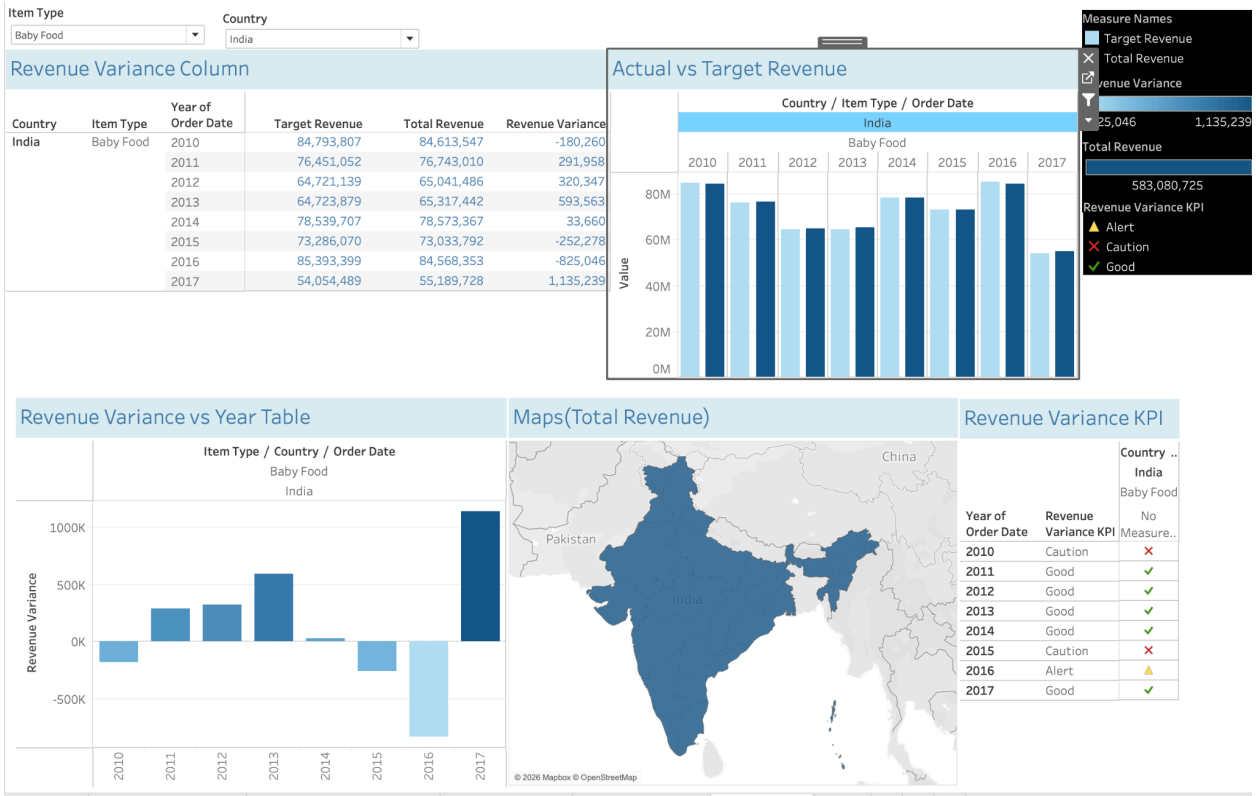
The analysis is based on two primary datasets. The *SALES_RECORDS* dataset contains transactional sales data at a daily level, including information such as revenue, order date, country, and item type. In contrast, the *TARGET_SALES* dataset provides aggregated monthly target values that serve as benchmarks for performance evaluation.

A key challenge in this project was the difference in data granularity between the two datasets. While the sales data is recorded at the daily level, the target data is summarized monthly. To ensure accurate comparisons, the sales data was aggregated to match the monthly or yearly level of the target data. This step was critical to prevent inconsistencies or misleading variance calculations and to maintain the integrity of the analysis.

3. Dashboard Design and Structure

The dashboard has been structured to provide a holistic view of sales performance through five key visualizations, supported by interactive filters. The design emphasizes clarity, logical organization, and ease of navigation, allowing users to quickly interpret trends and drill down into specific segments.

Dashboard Overview



The layout integrates tabular analysis, comparative charts, geographic mapping, and KPI indicators to ensure that both detailed and high-level insights are accessible within a single interface.

4. Key Visualizations and Analysis

The **Revenue Variance Table** provides a detailed year-wise comparison of target revenue, actual revenue, and the resulting variance. This visualization serves as the foundation for the analysis, enabling users to quantify performance gaps directly. It highlights years where sales either exceeded expectations or fell short, making it particularly useful for identifying anomalies and trends over time.

The **Actual vs Target Revenue Bar Chart** offers a visual comparison of actual and target revenues for each year. By placing these values side by side, the chart allows for immediate identification of performance gaps. This visualization simplifies the interpretation of whether targets were met and provides a clear representation of performance consistency across different periods.

The **Revenue Variance vs Year Chart** focuses specifically on the difference between actual and target revenues. This visualization emphasizes fluctuations in performance and helps

identify years with significant deviations. Notably, it highlights periods of underperformance as well as recovery phases, making it valuable for trend analysis and performance evaluation.

The **Geographic Revenue Map** presents total revenue distribution across countries. This visualization enables users to understand regional contributions to overall sales and supports geographic comparisons. It also integrates seamlessly with dashboard filters, allowing for focused analysis of specific regions or markets.

The **Revenue Variance KPI Table** classifies performance into categories such as “Good,” “Caution,” and “Alert” based on predefined variance thresholds. This scorecard-style visualization enhances decision-making by summarizing performance in a concise and actionable format. It allows users to quickly identify critical periods that require attention without needing to interpret raw numerical data.

5. Interactivity and Filters

The dashboard incorporates interactive filters for **Item Type** and **Country**, allowing users to dynamically refine the analysis. These filters enable deeper exploration of the data by focusing on specific product categories or geographic regions.

This interactivity enhances the usability of the dashboard by supporting both high-level overviews and detailed, segment-specific insights. Users can easily switch between different perspectives, making the dashboard adaptable to a variety of analytical needs.

6. Calculated Fields

To support the analysis, calculated fields were created within Tableau. The primary metric used is **Revenue Variance**, defined as the difference between total revenue and target revenue. This metric forms the basis for several visualizations and performance evaluations.

Additionally, a KPI classification logic was implemented to categorize performance into meaningful groups. This classification enables quick interpretation of results and enhances the dashboard’s effectiveness as a decision-support tool.

7. Key Insights

The analysis reveals that overall sales performance demonstrates a pattern of moderate consistency, with certain periods of significant deviation. While several years show alignment with or slight exceedance of targets, there are notable instances of underperformance.

In particular, one year stands out as a significant decline in performance, indicating potential operational or market challenges during that period. This is followed by a strong recovery in the subsequent year, suggesting effective corrective measures or improved market conditions.

The KPI classification further reinforces these observations by clearly distinguishing between stable, cautionary, and critical periods. This layered approach to analysis ensures that both quantitative and qualitative insights are effectively communicated.

8. Business Value

This dashboard provides substantial value by enabling continuous monitoring of sales performance against targets. It supports early identification of performance issues, allowing organizations to take proactive corrective actions.

Furthermore, the integration of geographic and product-level analysis facilitates targeted strategic planning. Decision-makers can identify high-performing regions or categories and allocate resources more effectively. The dashboard also enhances communication by presenting complex data in a structured and visually intuitive format.

9. Conclusion

The Tableau dashboard successfully delivers a comprehensive and interactive analysis of sales performance relative to targets. By addressing data granularity challenges and integrating multiple visualization techniques, the project ensures both accuracy and clarity.

The combination of detailed tables, comparative charts, geographic insights, and KPI indicators creates a robust analytical tool that supports informed decision-making. Overall, the dashboard demonstrates the effective use of data visualization to transform raw data into actionable business insights.